

CLARIFIES THE STATUS OF FOREIGN AGENCIES

State Department Says Law Does Not Question Their Loyalty

WASHINGTON, Oct. 20 (AP).—The State Department stressed today that the fact that agents of foreign principals were required to register did not bring into question their loyalty to American principles. The department, in a formal statement, said that it had been informed by several agents of foreign principals who have registered with it under the act of June 8, 1938, that "as a result of their registration their patriotism and their loyalty to American principles has been impugned."

In response to a request for a statement to counteract this im-

pression the department declared: "The department takes this opportunity to point out that registration under the act requiring the registration of agents of foreign principals is designed merely to show the exact nature of the connection of such an agent to his foreign principal."

"The act is broad in its terms and imposes the duty to register on many American citizens, companies and organizations whose work is of wholly unimpeachable character. The mere fact of registration under the act affords no ground for assuming that any person so registered is engaged in unpatriotic activity."